

Daniel Radcliffe and the Art of Playing a "Weird Little Guy"

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A film writer says has a fun way to see how far Daniel Radcliffe has come since the Harry Potter movies. In an **opinion piece**, the writer recommends the 2016 movie "Swiss Army Man," now on **Netflix**. Daniel Scheinert and Daniel Kwan, known as "the Daniels," wrote and **directed** it. They later made "Everything Everywhere All at Once." The writer calls the movie "absolutely wild in the best way."

The writer also uses the phrase "weird little guy." It describes an actor who can turn into strange, unusual characters. The writer says it is about a state of mind, not size. Radcliffe, the writer says, is a great example.

Since Harry Potter, Radcliffe has worked hard to avoid being tied to that role. His roles include a man who grows horns in "Horns" and a sneaky **villain** in "Now You See Me 2." He has also done **stage work** and won his first **Tony Award** for "Merrily We Roll Along." In 2026 he stars with Tracy Morgan in a comedy called "The Fall and Rise of Reggie Dinkins."

Word Treasure

opinion piece -- An article that shares the writer's own views.

stage work -- Acting in plays and musicals.

Netflix -- A company that streams movies and shows.

directed -- Led the making of a movie, including how it looks and feels.

villain -- A character who works against the hero.

Tony Award -- A major award for theater.

Break it down

Opening: a writer's idea for seeing Radcliffe's growth

The movie "Swiss Army Man" and its makers

The phrase "weird little guy"

Radcliffe's roles since Harry Potter

Stage work, a Tony Award and a 2026 comedy

Why it matters

The article shows how an actor known for one famous role can try many different kinds of parts, and it gives readers ideas for what to watch.

Test what you remember

1. Which movie does the writer recommend?

- ☐ (A) Horns
- ☐ (B) Swiss Army Man
- ☐ (C) The Lost City
- ☐ (D) Harry Potter

2. Where is the movie streaming?

- ☐ (A) Netflix
- ☐ (B) A school TV
- ☐ (C) A library
- ☐ (D) A movie theater only

3. Who wrote and directed the movie?

- ☐ (A) Tracy Morgan and Paul Dano
- ☐ (B) Daniel Radcliffe alone
- ☐ (C) Daniel Scheinert and Daniel Kwan
- ☐ (D) Harry Potter's author

4. What does "weird little guy" describe?

- ☐ (A) A very short person
- ☐ (B) An actor who can turn into strange, unusual characters
- ☐ (C) A type of movie camera
- ☐ (D) A cartoon character

5. What did Radcliffe win for "Merrily We Roll Along"?

- ☐ (A) A soccer trophy
- ☐ (B) A race
- ☐ (C) A school prize
- ☐ (D) His first Tony Award

6. Who stars with Radcliffe in "The Fall and Rise of Reggie Dinkins"?

- ☐ (A) Tracy Morgan
- ☐ (B) Paul Dano
- ☐ (C) Nicholas Hoult
- ☐ (D) Robert Pattinson

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: B 2: A 3: C 4: B 5: D 6: A

Questions to think about

1. The film writer: Says Radcliffe is a great example of a "weird little guy" and recommends "Swiss Army Man."

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):